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with Fundraising Expertise

April 8, 2013

Mr. Ray McCutcheon, Manager
Borough of Coraopolis
1012 5th Avenue
Coraopolis, PA 15108

Re: Ohio River Trail – Phase I

Dear Mr. McCutcheon:

On behalf of the Outdoor Recreation Partnership (ORP), I am writing in support of the Ohio River Trail – Phase 1 project. Based in Southwestern Pennsylvania, ORP is a voluntary network of independent agencies and organizations that work together to make outdoor recreation a hallmark of quality of life in this region.

The majority of Partners regularly utilize and promote the trail system. From leading hikes and bike rides, to planting native species and removing invasives, to using the trails to get to work and to access streams and rivers for fishing, we partner with volunteers, members, kids, adults, men and women in experiencing and treasuring these trails.

Trail infrastructure enables our residents and visitors to get healthy and experience nature—not to mention supporting the local economy through equipment rentals, meals, refreshments and perhaps an overnight stay. ORP supports the Ohio River Trail Council's efforts in preparing the engineering specifications and beginning construction of the 2.5-miles of the Ohio River Trail through Coraopolis, Moon Township and to Sewickley via the Sewickley Bridge.

This project is in line with many of the recommendations outlined in Pennsylvania's 2009-2013 Statewide Comprehensive Outdoor Recreation Plan such as 1) Strengthening Connections Between Outdoor Recreation, Healthy Lifestyles and Economic Benefits in Communities; 2) Reconnect People to the Outdoors and Develop a Stewardship Ethic Through Outdoor Recreation Opportunities and Experiences; and 3) Develop a Statewide Land and Water Trail Network to Facilitate Recreation, Transportation and Healthy Lifestyles. We look forward to working with Coraopolis and all of the ORTC partners in seeing this project to completion.

Sincerely,

Donna Bour, ORP Facilitator

On behalf of the following organizations: Bike Pittsburgh, Bour Associates, Family Tyes, Friends of the Riverfront, Pennsylvania Environmental Council, The Progress Fund, Sustainable Pittsburgh, Three Rivers Rowing Association, and Venture Outdoors